

Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011

A product-differentiated pre-pack declaration checklist — what every package must carry, and exactly where each product category departs from that baseline.

Source document: G.S.R. 202(E) dated 7 March 2011, notified under section 52(1) read with section 52(2)(j) and (q) of the Legal Metrology Act, 2009 (1 of 2010); in force from 1 April 2011. Includes the amendments noted in the source text (G.S.R. 734(E) dated 30.09.2011 and G.S.R. 748(E) dated 24.10.2011).

How this document is built. Chapter II of the Rules imposes one common set of declarations on every retail package. The Rules then carve that baseline up in four different ways — by *exemption* (Rules 3 and 26), by *overriding law* (food, drugs, cosmetics, seeds, liquor), by *unit of declaration* (Fourth Schedule) and by *mandatory pack size* (Second Schedule). Section 2 below is the baseline every SKU must clear. Section 4 is the differentiator: one block per product category listing only what changes for that category.

SECTION	WHAT IT COVERS	USE IT WHEN
1 Scope gate	Rules 3 and 26 — whether the Rules apply to the SKU at all	First screen for any new product
2 Core checklist	Rules 4–13 — the mandatory declarations, principal display panel, legibility, units	Every retail package, without exception
3 Differentiation matrix	One-row-per-category summary of unit, pack size, date marking, MRP and overriding law	Choosing which category block applies
4 Category checklists	Thirty product-category blocks — only the deltas from the baseline	Artwork sign-off for a specific SKU
5 Reference tables	Schedules I–IV and the Rule 7 numeral-height tables	Verifying a number against the Rules
6 Trade channel	Wholesale packages, imports, exports, dealer duties (Rules 18, 24, 25)	Packing, importing or shelf audit
7 Registration, inspection, penalty	Rules 19–23 and 27–32, Schedules V–VII	Company-level readiness, not artwork

Read this before using the checklist

This checklist restates the requirements of the 2011 Rules as extracted from the notified text supplied. It is a working artwork-review aid, not legal advice, and it does not cover the parallel labelling duties imposed by the FSS Act and regulations, the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945, the Seeds Act, 1966, State excise law or BIS standards — each of which overrides or adds to these Rules for specific categories, as flagged in Section 4. Several provisions in the source text are marked as withdrawn or amended with effect from 1 July 2012; those are shown in amber where they appear.

1 Scope gate — does Chapter II apply to this SKU?

Run these questions before anything else. A 'yes' on any exclusion means the retail-package declaration set in Section 2 does not apply, though other obligations may.

☐	R. 3(a)	Is the net quantity more than 25 kg or 25 litre? If yes, Chapter II does not apply — <i>except</i> cement and fertiliser sold in bags up to 50 kg, which remain fully covered.
☐	R. 3(b)	Is the pack meant for an industrial or institutional consumer? Institutional = transport, airways, railways, hotels, hospitals or other service institutions buying direct from the manufacturer for their own use. Industrial = an industry buying direct from the manufacturer for use in that industry. Either way Chapter II is out. Anything routed through a dealer or reaching a retail shelf is <i>not</i> institutional.
☐	R. 26(a)	Is net weight 10 g / 10 ml or less? The Rules do not apply. Note the proviso in the source text requiring MRP and net quantity on 10–20 g and 10–20 ml packs — marked in the source as withdrawn w.e.f. 01.07.2012.
☐	R. 26(b)	Is it fast food packed by a restaurant, hotel or the like? Exempt.
☐	R. 26(c)	Is it a scheduled or non-scheduled formulation under the Drugs (Price Control) Order, 1995? Exempt from these Rules; the DPCO and the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules govern instead.
☐	R. 26(d)	Is it agricultural farm produce in packs above 50 kg? Exempt.
☐	R. 2(k)	Confirm the pack is a 'retail package' — intended for retail sale to the ultimate consumer, including imported packages. Ultimate consumer excludes industrial and institutional consumers.
☐	R. 2(r)	If it holds ten or more labelled retail packs, or is sold to an intermediary, it is a wholesale package — go to Section 6.1 instead of Section 2.

The cement and fertiliser exception

Rule 3(a) lifts the 25 kg ceiling only for cement and fertiliser, and only up to 50 kg. A 50 kg cement bag therefore carries the full retail declaration set including MRP, while a 30 kg bag of almost anything else does not.

2 Core checklist — every retail package

Rule 4 bars pre-packing for sale, distribution or delivery unless the package, or a label securely affixed to it, bears these declarations. Rule 19(7) allows compliance to be ensured at the factory or at the factory depot; the explanation to Rule 4 confirms that packs inside the manufacturer's premises without an MRP are not a violation, but nothing may leave the premises without it.

2.1 The mandatory declarations (Rule 6)

☐	6(1)(a)	Name and complete address of the manufacturer. If the manufacturer is not the packer, both names and addresses. For imported packs, the importer's name and address.
☐	Expl. I	If a name and address appears without the qualifier 'manufactured by' or 'packed by', it is presumed to be the manufacturer's and liability follows accordingly. Decide deliberately whether to add the qualifier.
☐	Expl. II	If the brand owner's name and address appears as 'marketer', the brand owner is liable as deemed manufacturer. Where several names appear, prosecution is launched against the one named first — so the order of names on the panel is a legal decision, not a design one.
☐	6(1)(b)	Common or generic name of the commodity. For multi-product packs, the name and number or quantity of <i>each</i> product.
☐	6(1)(c)	Net quantity in the standard unit of weight or measure, or the count if the commodity is sold by number. Verify the unit against the Fourth Schedule (Section 5.4) before accepting it.
☐	6(1)(d)	Month and year of manufacture, pre-packing or import. May be in words, numerals, or both. See the category blocks — food, cosmetics and seeds are governed by other laws, and bidi, incense sticks and PSU LPG cylinders are exempt.
☐	6(1)(e)	Retail sale price as 'Maximum retail price Rs ... inclusive of all taxes' or 'MRP Rs ... incl. of all taxes'. Rounding per Rule 2(m): a fraction below fifty paise rounds down to the preceding rupee; fifty to ninety-five paise rounds to fifty paise.

☐	6(1)(f)	Dimensions of the commodity where size is relevant — and the dimensions of each piece separately if the pieces differ.
☐	6(2)	Consumer-complaint contact: name, address, telephone number and e-mail address if available, of the person or office to be contacted. This is a separate, standalone requirement — not satisfied by the manufacturer's address alone.
☐	6(1)(g)	Any other matter specified in these Rules — for example sheet count (R. 16), finished dimensions of textiles (R. 14), container dimensions (R. 17).

2.2 Stickers, wrappers and combination packs

☐	6(3)	No sticker may be affixed to alter or make a mandatory declaration. The single permitted exception is a sticker showing a <i>reduced</i> MRP inclusive of all taxes, which must not cover the original MRP printed by the manufacturer or packer.
☐	6(4)	Stickers remain permissible for declarations that are <i>not</i> required by these Rules — promotional claims, batch codes and the like.
☐	6(5)	Multi-component commodity sold as one item: the Rule 6(1) declarations go on the main pack, which must also carry information about the accompanying packs. Alternatively, declare on each individual pack and say so on the main pack. If components are sold as spare parts, every pack carries the full declaration set.
☐	6(6)	Legacy wrappers that could not be exhausted could be used up to 31 March 2012 (extended by G.S.R. 734(E)) after correction by stamping, sticker or on-line printing. Treat as spent — retain only as context for old-stock disputes.
☐	9(3)	Outer container or wrapper must repeat every declaration, unless it is transparent and the declarations on the inner pack read clearly through it. If the inner pack carries no declaration on its outer cover, none is required on it.

2.3 Principal display panel, size and placement (Rules 7 and 8)

☐	7(1)	Pack of five cubic centimetres or less: the principal display panel may be a card or tape firmly affixed to the pack, carrying the required information.
☐	7(2)	Numeral height meets Table I (quantity by weight or volume) or Table II (by length, area or number). Full tables at Section 5.5.
☐	7(3)	Letter height at least 1 mm; at least 2 mm where blown, formed, moulded, embossed or perforated. Letter or numeral width at least one-third of its height , except numeral '1' and the letters i, l and I.
☐	7(4)	Rules 7(1)–(3) do not apply where the same information is also required by any other law in force — the relevant category block flags where this bites.
☐	8(1)	All declarations appear on the principal display panel , and the area around the quantity declaration is free of printed matter: clear space above and below at least equal to the numeral height, and to left and right at least twice the numeral height. Measure this on the artwork, not by eye.
☐	2(h)	Grouping is permitted two ways: everything together in one place, or pre-printed information grouped in one place and on-line printed information grouped in another.

2.4 Manner of declaration (Rules 9 and 10)

☐	9(1)(a)	Every declaration is legible and prominent .
☐	9(1)(b)	Numerals of MRP and net quantity are printed, painted or inscribed in a colour that contrasts conspicuously with the label background. Contrast is not required where the information is blown, formed or moulded on glass or plastic. Hand-written or hand-scripted declarations must still be clear, unambiguous and legible.
☐	9(2)	No declaration may need to be read through a liquid contained in the pack. Check this on the filled pack, not the empty one.
☐	9(4)	Declarations are in Hindi in Devanagari script or in English . Any additional language is permitted alongside.
☐	10(1)	'Complete address' means the postal address of the factory; otherwise street name, premises number, and either city and State or the PIN code — enough for a consumer to identify and locate the manufacturer, packer or importer.
☐	10(1)	Packs of 5 cc or less: a mark or inscription enabling the consumer to identify the manufacturer, packer or importer is sufficient compliance.

☐	10(1)	Foreign-made goods packed in India: the principal display panel must also carry the name and complete address of the Indian packer or importer.
☐	10(2)	The name used is the actual corporate name , or if unincorporated, the name under which the business is conducted in India. A trading style or brand name alone does not satisfy this.
☐	28	A registered shorter address may be used on the label if the Director or Controller has registered it under Rule 28 in addition to the complete address.

2.5 Quantity: what the number must mean (Rules 11–13, 23, 31)

☐	11(1)	Net quantity excludes wrappers and all non-commodity material.
☐	11(2)	Where the commodity will not vary with environmental conditions, the declared quantity is what the consumer actually receives, and must not be qualified by 'when packed' or similar.
☐	11(3)	Where variation is negligible , declare after allowing for it so the consumer receives not less than the declared quantity — again with no 'when packed' qualifier.
☐	11(4)	Only commodities in the Third Schedule may be qualified 'when packed': all kinds of soaps, lotions, and cream other than cream of milk. Nothing else.
☐	12(2)	Unit follows the physical form — mass for solid, semi-solid, viscous or solid-liquid mixtures; length, area, volume or number as applicable — except the commodities listed in the Fourth Schedule (Section 5.4).
☐	12(3)	Where quantity is declared by mass, an additional count declaration is optional.
☐	12(4)	Where weight, measure or number alone does not fully inform the consumer, add a declaration of dimensions or number, or both.
☐	12(5)	Any additional information about the commodity appears on the same panel as the mandatory declarations.
☐	12(6)	No hedging words. 'Minimum', 'not less than', 'average', 'about', 'approximately' and words of similar nature are barred from the quantity declaration. As amended w.e.f. 01.07.2012 this extends to any word or expression whatsoever that creates or is likely to create an exaggerated, misleading or inadequate impression.
☐	12(7)	Packs of 5 cc or less: quantity may be declared on a tag, card or tape affixed so it cannot be removed without opening the container, and carrying a mark identifying the manufacturer or packer.
☐	13(2)	Below one kilogram / metre / square metre / cubic metre / cubic decimetre / litre, use gram, centimetre, square decimetre, cubic centimetre, cubic centimetre and millilitre respectively.
☐	13(3)	At or above those thresholds use the base unit, expressing fractions as decimal sub-multiples or in the smaller unit. A quantity exactly equal to one of those units may be expressed either way at the packer's option.
☐	13(4)	Dozen, score, gross and great gross are prohibited on any package.
☐	13(5)	Only SI units may be used for net quantity. Items sold by number use the symbol N or U .
☐	23	Not a deceptive package. A pack deliberately designed to give an exaggerated or misleading impression of quantity must be repacked or relabelled, failing which it is seized. Oversizing is defensible only where needed to protect the commodity or to suit the filling machine — document that justification at design stage.
☐	31	Advertising carry-over: any advertisement stating the MRP of a pre-packaged commodity must also declare net quantity or number, in the same font size as the retail sale price.

Standard pack sizes and the withdrawn 'non-standard' legend

Rule 5 requires the commodities in the Second Schedule to be packed only in the quantities specified there (Section 3 and the category blocks). The proviso permitting an off-schedule size carrying the legend 'Not a standard pack size under the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011' is marked in the source text as withdrawn w.e.f. 01.07.2012 by G.S.R. 748(E). Plan Second Schedule SKUs to a listed size rather than relying on the legend.

3 Product differentiation matrix

One row per category. 'Baseline' means the core checklist in Section 2 applies unchanged on that axis. Use this to find the right block in Section 4.

PRODUCT CATEGORY	UNIT OF DECLARATION	MANDATORY PACK SIZE (SCH. II)	MONTH / YEAR MARKING	MRP	OVERRIDING LAW
Baby food, weaning food	Weight	100–900 g in 100 g steps; 1, 2, 5, 10 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Milk powder	Weight	<50 g free; 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1 kg, then ×500 g	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Biscuits	Weight	25, 50, 75, 100, 150, 200, 250, 300 g, then ×100 g to 1 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Bread (excl. bun)	Weight	100 g, then multiples of 100 g	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Butter, margarine (un-canned)	Weight	25, 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1, 2, 5 kg, then ×5 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Cereals and pulses	Weight	100, 200, 500 g, 1, 2, 5 kg, then ×5 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Rice powder, flour, atta, rawa, suji	Weight	100, 200, 500 g, 1, 2, 5 kg, then ×5 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Coffee	Weight	25, 50, 100, 200, 250, 500 g, 1 kg, then ×1 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Tea	Weight	25, 50, 100, 125, 250, 500 g, 1 kg, then ×1 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Beverage-mix materials	Weight	25, 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1 kg, then ×1 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Edible oil, vanaspati, ghee, butter oil	Weight or volume (Sch. IV)	50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1, 2, 3, 5 kg, then ×5 kg — same figures in ml or l if declared by volume	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Salt	Weight	<50 g in 10 g steps; 50, 100, 200, 500, 750 g, 1, 2, 5 kg, then ×5 kg	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Aerated soft drinks, non-alcoholic beverages	Volume	65 ml*, 100, 125 ml*, 150, 200, 250, 300, 330 ml (cans only), 500, 750 ml, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 4, 5 l	Food law applies	May be on crown cap or bottle (R. 8(2))	FSS / PFA
Mineral and drinking water	Volume	100, 150, 200, 250, 300, 500, 750 ml, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 4, 5 l	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Alcoholic beverages, spirituous liquor	Volume	Baseline	Baseline	State excise law prevails; these Rules apply only if excise law is silent	State excise
Curd, sweets (rasgulla, gulabjamun), sauces, honey, malt extract, syrup	Weight (Sch. IV)	Baseline	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Ice cream, similar frozen products	Volume — amended to weight w.e.f. 01.07.2012	Baseline	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Fruits, all kinds	Number or weight (Sch. IV)	Baseline	Food law applies	Required	FSS / PFA
Cosmetics — cream, shampoo, lotion, perfume	Weight or measure (Sch. IV)	Baseline	Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 apply	Required	D&C Rules 1945
Drug formulations under DPCO 1995	—	—	—	—	Wholly exempt (R. 26(c))

PRODUCT CATEGORY	UNIT OF DECLARATION	MANDATORY PACK SIZE (SCH. II)	MONTH / YEAR MARKING	MRP	OVERRIDING LAW
Toilet soap, laundry soap, NSD cakes and bars	Weight, may be qualified ' when packed '	Toilet 25–150 g then ×50 g; laundry 50, 75, 100 g then ×50 g; NSD cake to 300 g then ×100 g	Baseline	Required	—
Non-soapy detergent powder	Weight	<50 g free; 50, 100, 200, 500, 700 g, 1, 1.5, 2 kg, then ×1 kg	Baseline	Required	—
Lotions; cream other than cream of milk	Weight or measure, may be qualified ' when packed '	Baseline	Cosmetic: D&C Rules	Required	D&C Rules 1945
Paint, varnish, varnish stain, enamel	Volume (Sch. IV)	50, 100, 200, 500 ml, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 l, then ×5 l	Baseline	Required	—
Paste paint, solid paint	Weight (Sch. IV)	500 g, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 5, 7 kg, then ×5 kg	Baseline	Required	—
Base paint	Volume	450, 500, 900, 925, 950, 975 ml, 1 l, 3.6, 3.7, 3.8, 3.9, 4 l; free above 4 l	Baseline	Required	—
Cement in bags	Weight	1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 25, 40 kg (white only), 50 kg	Baseline	Required	Covered up to 50 kg
Fertiliser in bags	Weight	Baseline	Baseline	Required	Covered up to 50 kg
Aerosol products	Weight (Sch. IV)	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Acids in liquid form, liquid chemicals	Weight or volume	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Compressed or liquefied gas (not LPG)	Weight and equivalent volume at stated temperature and pressure	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Domestic LPG cylinder 14.2 / 5 kg (PSU)	Weight	Baseline	Exempt (R. 6 proviso A(ii))	Exempt if price under APM	—
Furnace oil, non-edible vegetable oil	Weight or volume	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Heavy residual fuel oil	Weight	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Industrial diesel fuel	Volume	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Electric cable, electric wire	Length or weight	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Fencing wire, nails, wood screws	Number or weight	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Yarn	Weight or length	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Tyres and tubes	Number	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Ready-made garments	Number	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Bed-sheets, sarees, dhoties, towels, napkins, pillow covers, table cloths	Number plus finished dimensions (R. 14)	Baseline	Baseline	Required — also on each piece	—
Aluminium foil, facial tissue, waxed paper, toilet paper	Quantity plus usable sheet count and sheet dimensions (R. 16)	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Bags, boxes, cups, pans sold as containers	Number plus dimensions (R. 17)	Baseline	Baseline	Required	—
Bidi	Number	Baseline	Exempt	Exempt	—
Incense sticks	Number or weight	Baseline	Exempt	Required	—

PRODUCT CATEGORY	UNIT OF DECLARATION	MANDATORY PACK SIZE (SCH. II)	MONTH / YEAR MARKING	MRP	OVERRIDING LAW
Seeds certified under the Seeds Act, 1966	Weight or number	Baseline	Exempt from R. 6(1)(d)	Required	Seeds Act 1966

* 65 ml and 125 ml are permitted for fruit-based drinks only; 330 ml in cans only. 'FSS / PFA' reflects the source text's reference to the Prevention of Food Adulteration Act, 1954, whose labelling function is now discharged by the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and the regulations made under it.

4 Category checklists — the deltas

Each block assumes Section 2 has already been cleared. Tick only the differences that apply to the category. Where a block says an item is governed by another law, the Legal Metrology requirement is displaced, not merely duplicated — Rule 7(4) also switches off the numeral-height rules wherever another law in force requires the same information.

4.1 Food and beverage

4.1.1. Packaged food articles — general

Applies to: Any commodity that is a 'food article' within the meaning of the food law.

☐	6(1)(a) Expl. III	Manufacturer name and address is NOT governed by Rule 6(1)(a). The food law's requirement applies instead. Do not review this field against Rule 6.
☐	6(1)(d) proviso	Month and year marking is NOT governed by Rule 6(1)(d). The food law's date-marking rules apply — typically date of manufacture with 'best before' or 'use before'.
☐	6 proviso (B)	Carry-over of pre-printed packaging into the next month is barred for food products whose 'best before' or 'use before' period is ninety days or less from the date of manufacture or packing. Flag every short-shelf-life SKU in the packaging-stock policy.
☐	6(1)(e)	MRP declaration remains fully governed by these Rules.
☐	6(1)(c)	Net quantity remains fully governed by these Rules, including the Fourth Schedule unit and the Second Schedule pack size where the commodity is listed.

Watch the interface: it is common to see a food label correctly dated under food law but with an MRP that fails Rule 2(m) rounding, or a net quantity in a non-standard pack size. The two regimes are reviewed separately.

4.1.2. Baby food, weaning food and milk powder

Applies to: Infant and weaning formulations; milk powder in all pack forms.

Unit of declaration: Weight

Standard pack sizes (Sch. II): Baby and weaning food: 100–900 g in 100 g steps, 1, 2, 5, 10 kg. Milk powder: free below 50 g, then 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1 kg, then ×500 g.

☐	5 / Sch. II	Pack size is one of the listed quantities. Baby and weaning food: 100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800, 900 g, 1, 2, 5 and 10 kg. Milk powder: no restriction below 50 g, then 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1 kg and thereafter multiples of 500 g.
☐	12(2)(a)	Declared by weight — these are solids or powders and are not in the Fourth Schedule.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.
☐	Sch. I	Maximum permissible error taken from Table I of the First Schedule against the declared quantity band.

4.1.3. Biscuits, bread and bakery

Applies to: Biscuits; bread including brown bread but excluding bun.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	5 / Sch. II	Biscuits: 25, 50, 75, 100, 150, 200, 250, 300 g and thereafter in multiples of 100 g up to 1 kg. Bread: 100 g and thereafter in multiples of 100 g.
☐	Sch. II	Bun is expressly excluded from the bread entry — no mandatory size applies to it.
☐	11(2)	Bread loses moisture in storage, but bread is not in the Third Schedule: 'when packed' may not be used. Declare so the consumer receives not less than the declared quantity.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.

4.1.4. Cereals, pulses, flour, atta, rawa, suji and rice powder

Applies to: Staples sold by weight in retail packs.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	5 / Sch. II	100 g, 200 g, 500 g, 1 kg, 2 kg, 5 kg and thereafter in multiples of 5 kg — for both the cereals and pulses entry and the flour group.
☐	3(a)	A pack above 25 kg falls outside Chapter II entirely: a 30 kg atta bag is not a covered retail package, but a 25 kg one is.
☐	26(d)	Agricultural farm produce above 50 kg is exempt. Milled and branded staples in retail packs are not farm produce and stay covered.
☐	11(3)	Allow for negligible moisture variation in the declared figure; the 'when packed' qualifier is not available for these commodities.

4.1.5. Tea, coffee and beverage-mix powders**Applies to:** Tea, coffee, and materials that may be constituted or reconstituted as beverages.**Unit of declaration:** Weight

☐	5 / Sch. II	Tea: 25, 50, 100, 125, 250, 500 g, 1 kg, then multiples of 1 kg. Coffee: 25, 50, 100, 200, 250, 500 g, 1 kg, then multiples of 1 kg. Beverage-mix materials: 25, 50, 100, 200, 500 g, 1 kg, then multiples of 1 kg.
☐	Sch. II	Note the divergence: tea has a 125 g size and no 200 g; coffee has 200 g and no 125 g. These are frequently confused on artwork.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.

4.1.6. Edible oil, vanaspati, ghee and butter oil**Applies to:** All edible oils and fats in retail packs.**Unit of declaration:** Weight or volume at the packer's option — with mandatory mass in brackets if volume is chosen

☐	Sch. IV item 11	May be declared by weight OR volume — one of the few categories with a genuine choice.
☐	Sch. II item 10	Standard sizes: 50 g, 100 g, 200 g, 500 g, 1, 2, 3, 5 kg and thereafter in multiples of 5 kg. If declared by volume, the same numbers in millilitres or litres.
☐	Sch. II item 10	If the net quantity is declared by volume, the equivalent quantity in terms of mass must also be declared in brackets, in letters and numerals of the same size. This dual declaration is unique to this category — check the bracketed text is not reduced in point size.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.

4.1.7. Salt**Applies to:** Edible salt in retail packs.**Unit of declaration:** Weight

☐	5 / Sch. II	Below 50 g in multiples of 10 g; then 50, 100, 200, 500, 750 g, 1, 2, 5 kg and thereafter in multiples of 5 kg. Note the 750 g size, which is unusual.
☐	26(a)	Packs of 10 g or less fall outside the Rules altogether.
☐	12(2)(a)	Declared by weight.

4.1.8. Aerated soft drinks and non-alcoholic beverages**Applies to:** Carbonated drinks, fruit-based drinks, ready-to-serve beverages.**Unit of declaration:** Volume

☐	5 / Sch. II	65 ml (fruit-based drinks only), 100 ml, 125 ml (fruit-based drinks only), 150, 200, 250, 300 ml, 330 ml (in cans only), 500, 750 ml, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 4 and 5 litre.
☐	8(2)	Returnable refillable bottles: the MRP may be shown on the crown cap, on the bottle, or on both; where shown on cap or bottle the short form ' MRP Rs ... ' suffices. This is the only place the full 'inclusive of all taxes' wording is relaxed.

☐	9(2)	No declaration may require reading through the liquid — particularly relevant to clear PET and glass. Verify on the filled bottle.
☐	9(1)(b) proviso	Information blown, formed or moulded on the glass or plastic surface need not be in a contrasting colour.
☐	7(3)	Blown, formed, moulded, embossed or perforated letters need 2 mm minimum height, and numerals take the higher column of Table I.

4.1.9. Packaged drinking water and mineral water

Applies to: Bottled drinking water and mineral water.

Unit of declaration: Volume

☐	5 / Sch. II	100, 150, 200, 250, 300, 500, 750 ml, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 4 and 5 litre. There is no 125 ml or 330 ml size for water — those belong to the soft-drink entry.
☐	9(2)	Declarations must be legible without reading through the water.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law; BIS certification marking obligations apply in parallel and are outside these Rules.

4.1.10. Alcoholic beverages and spirituous liquor

Applies to: All liquor in packaged form.

☐	6(1)(e) proviso	MRP is governed by the State excise law and rules of the State in which the product is manufactured. These Rules apply to the price declaration only where the State excise law is silent on it.
☐	6(1)(a)–(d)	All other declarations — manufacturer and packer identity, generic name, net quantity, month and year — remain governed by these Rules unless displaced.
☐	9(4)	The language requirement applies; State excise labelling requirements are additional.

Build the MRP field State by State. A single national artwork will usually not clear excise scrutiny in every State.

4.1.11. Curd, sweets, sauces, honey and syrups

Applies to: Curd; rasgulla, gulabjamun and other sweet preparations; sauces of all kinds; honey, malt extract, golden syrup, treacle.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	Sch. IV	All of these are declared by WEIGHT , notwithstanding that several are liquid or semi-liquid. This is the most commonly missed Fourth Schedule entry — a sauce or honey bottle declared in millilitres is non-compliant.
☐	12(2)	The general rule in Rule 12(2) is displaced for these commodities by the Fourth Schedule.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.

4.1.12. Ice cream and similar frozen products

Applies to: Ice cream, frozen desserts and similar products.

Unit of declaration: Weight (as amended) — volume in the unamended text

☐	Sch. IV item 15	Declared by volume in the notified text, amended to weight with effect from 01.07.2012 by G.S.R. 748(E). Current artwork should follow the amended position and declare by weight.
☐	11(2) / 11(4)	Frozen products are not in the Third Schedule — 'when packed' is not available.
☐	Expl. III / 6(1)(d)	Manufacturer identification and date marking follow food law.

This is a live divergence between the notified text and the 2011 amendment. Confirm the current consolidated position before sign-off.

4.1.13. Fruits and fresh produce

Applies to: Fruits of all kinds in packaged form.

Unit of declaration: Number or weight

☐	Sch. IV item 8	Declared by number or weight .
☐	26(d)	Agricultural farm produce in packs above 50 kg is exempt from the Rules entirely.
☐	3(a)	Packs above 25 kg fall outside Chapter II.
☐	13(5)(ii)	Where sold by number, the symbol is N or U — never 'pcs', 'nos' or 'dozen'.

4.2 Personal care, household and chemicals

4.2.1. Cosmetics — creams, shampoos, lotions and perfumes

Applies to: Products that are cosmetics within the meaning of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945.

Unit of declaration: Weight or measure

☐	6(1)(d) proviso	Month and year marking is governed by the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 , not by Rule 6(1)(d). Manufacturing date and expiry follow that regime.
☐	Sch. IV item 26	Declared by weight or measure .
☐	Sch. III items 2 and 3	Lotions and cream other than cream of milk may have the quantity qualified by the words ' when packed '. A shampoo or perfume may not.
☐	6(1)(e)	MRP remains governed by these Rules, including Rule 2(m) rounding.
☐	7(4)	Where the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules require the same information, the Rule 7 numeral-height requirements do not apply to it.

4.2.2. Drug formulations under the DPCO, 1995

Applies to: Scheduled and non-scheduled formulations covered by the Drugs (Price Control) Order, 1995 made under section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955.

☐	26(c)	Wholly exempt from these Rules. Do not apply the Section 2 checklist. Labelling, pack size and price are governed by the DPCO and the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules.
☐	26(c)	Confirm the product genuinely falls within the DPCO. A nutraceutical, food supplement or cosmetic sold alongside pharmaceuticals is not exempt and must clear the full Section 2 checklist.

The single most consequential misclassification in this document. Exemption depends on the product being a formulation under the DPCO, not on it being sold in a pharmacy.

4.2.3. Toilet soap, laundry soap and detergent cakes

Applies to: Toilet and bath soap cakes, laundry soap, non-soapy detergent cakes and bars.

Unit of declaration: Weight, may be qualified 'when packed'

☐	5 / Sch. II	Toilet soap including all kinds of bath soap cakes: 25, 50, 75, 100, 125, 150 g and thereafter in multiples of 50 g. Laundry soap: 50, 75, 100 g and thereafter in multiples of 50 g. Non-soapy detergent cakes and bars: 50, 75, 100, 125, 150, 200, 250, 300 g and thereafter in multiples of 100 g.
☐	Sch. III item 1	All kinds of soaps may be qualified 'when packed' — soap loses moisture in storage. This is one of only three commodities in the Third Schedule.
☐	21(3) proviso	Where the pack bears 'when packed', no punitive action lies against a retail or wholesale dealer if the officer is satisfied after testing that the shortfall is due to environmental conditions. This materially reduces channel risk — use the legend.
☐	22(3)	The Director, Controller or Legal Metrology Officer determines the reasonable variation attributable to environmental conditions.

4.2.4. Non-soapy detergent powder

Applies to: Washing powders and detergent powders.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	5 / Sch. II	No restriction below 50 g; then 50, 100, 200, 500, 700 g, 1 kg, 1.5 kg, 2 kg and thereafter in multiples of 1 kg. Note the 700 g and 1.5 kg sizes.
☐	Sch. III	Detergent powder is not 'soap' for the Third Schedule — do not use 'when packed' on powder packs unless the product is genuinely a soap.
☐	12(6)	No 'approximately' or 'average' against the quantity, however tempting for a hygroscopic powder.

4.2.5. Aerosols, acids, liquid chemicals and gases

Applies to: Aerosol products, acids in liquid form, liquid chemicals, compressed or liquefied gas other than LPG.

Unit of declaration: See each entry — the Fourth Schedule governs

☐	Sch. IV item 1	Aerosol products are declared by WEIGHT , not by the volume of the can. A common failure on personal-care aerosols.
☐	Sch. IV items 2 and 16	Acids in liquid form and liquid chemicals: weight or volume.
☐	Sch. IV item 3	Compressed or liquefied gas other than LPG: weight AND equivalent volume at a stated temperature and pressure . Both figures plus the reference conditions must appear.
☐	9(1)(b)	The contrast requirement applies to metal and moulded containers unless the information is blown, formed or moulded on a glass or plastic surface.

4.2.6. Domestic LPG cylinders

Applies to: Domestic liquefied petroleum gas cylinders of 14.2 kg or 5 kg bottled and marketed by a public sector undertaking.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	6 proviso A(ii)	No month and year of manufacture or pre-packing is required.
☐	6 proviso C(ii)	No retail sale price is required where the price is covered under the Administrative Price Mechanism of the Government.
☐	18(4)	Because month and year are not required, the Rule 18(3) machinery for revising price on a tax change does not apply.
☐	Sch. IV item 17	Liquefied petroleum gas is declared by weight .
☐	6 proviso A(ii)	Both conditions are cumulative: the exemption is for 14.2 kg or 5 kg cylinders bottled and marketed by a PSU. A private-sector or non-standard-size cylinder does not qualify.

4.2.7. Paints, varnishes and enamels

Applies to: Paint other than paste or solid paint, varnish, varnish stains, enamels, paste paint, solid paint and base paint.

Unit of declaration: Volume for liquid paint and varnish; weight for paste and solid paint

☐	Sch. IV items 19 and 20	Liquid paint, varnish, varnish stain and enamel: VOLUME. Paste paint and solid paint: WEIGHT. The split runs through both the unit and the pack-size table — classify the product first.
☐	Sch. II item 19(a)	Liquid paint, varnish, enamel: 50, 100, 200, 500 ml, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 litre and thereafter in multiples of 5 litre.
☐	Sch. II item 19(b)	Paste and solid paint: 500 g, 1, 1.5, 2, 3, 5, 7 kg and thereafter in multiples of 5 kg.
☐	Sch. II item 19(c)	Base paint: 450, 500, 900, 925, 950, 975 ml, 1 litre, 3.6, 3.7, 3.8, 3.9 and 4 litre, with no restriction above 4 litre — the tinting-base sizes are deliberately irregular.
☐	6(1)(f) / 23	Where the pack is a tinting base sold for in-store colouration, ensure the label does not create a misleading impression of the final dispensed quantity.

4.2.8. Fuels and industrial oils

Applies to: Furnace oil, non-edible vegetable oil, heavy residual fuel oil, industrial diesel fuel.

Unit of declaration: See each entry — the Fourth Schedule governs

☐	Sch. IV items 9 and 10	Furnace oil and non-edible vegetable oil: weight or volume .
☐	Sch. IV item 12	Heavy residual fuel oil: weight only.
☐	Sch. IV item 13	Industrial diesel fuel: volume only.
☐	3(b)	Most of this volume moves to industrial consumers direct from the manufacturer and is therefore outside Chapter II. Confirm the channel before applying the checklist at all.

4.3 Textiles, hardware and engineered goods

4.3.1. Textiles sold by piece — Rule 14 goods

Applies to: Bed-sheets, hemmed fabric materials, dhoties, sarees, napkins, pillow covers, towels, table cloths and similar commodities.

Unit of declaration: Number plus finished dimensions

☐	14	Declare both the number of pieces and the finished-size dimensions of the commodities on the pack or the label affixed to it.
☐	14 proviso 1	Where the pack contains more than one piece of different dimensions , declare the dimensions and the retail sale price of each such piece on the pack.
☐	14 proviso 2	The dimensions and the sale price must also be marked on each individual piece — not only on the outer pack. This is an item-level marking obligation, usually met by a sewn-in or attached tag.
☐	15	Where dimensions or weight bear a relationship to the price, the quantity declaration must include that dimension or weight.
☐	12(4)	Add the dimension declaration wherever weight or number alone does not fully inform the consumer.

4.3.2. Ready-made garments

Applies to: Garments sold ready-made in packaged form.

Unit of declaration: Number

☐	Sch. IV item 22	Declared by number .
☐	13(5)(ii)	Use the symbol N or U for the count.
☐	15	Where size or weight relates to price, that dimension or weight enters the quantity declaration.
☐	6(1)(f)	Where size is relevant — and for garments it is — declare the dimensions; where pieces in a pack differ, declare each.
☐	13(4)	A multi-pack may not be described as a 'dozen'.

4.3.3. Sheet products — Rule 16 goods

Applies to: Aluminium foil, facial tissues, waxed paper, toilet paper and any other type of sheet.

Unit of declaration: Quantity plus usable sheet count and per-sheet dimensions

☐	16	The quantity declaration must also include a statement of the number of usable sheets and the dimensions of each sheet .
☐	16	'Usable' is the operative word — a roll's gross length or a carton's gross sheet count is not the declaration. Perforated tails and glued ends are not usable sheets.
☐	12(5)	Sheet count and dimensions sit on the same panel as the other declarations.
☐	17(i)	Where the sheets are supplied in a perforated roll, the container-type rules in Rule 17 may also apply.

4.3.4. Container-type commodities — Rule 17 goods

Applies to: Bags, boxes, cups, pans and the like designed and sold in retail trade for use as containers for other materials or objects.

Unit of declaration: Number plus the prescribed dimensions

☐	17(i)	Bag-type: the number of bags the pack contains, followed by the linear dimensions of the bags — whether packaged in a perforated roll or otherwise.
☐	17(ii)	Square, oblong, rectangular or similar containers: the number of containers, followed by length, width and, if required, depth .
☐	17(iii)	Circular or round containers other than cups and the like: the number of commodities, followed by diameter and, if necessary, depth .
☐	17(iv)	Where the label relates the container's use to a standard weight or measure it can hold, that reference must be included in the quantity declaration — a '5 litre capacity' claim becomes part of the regulated declaration, not marketing copy.

4.3.5. Wire, cable, fasteners, yarn, tyres and tubes

Applies to: Electric cables and wires, fencing wire, nails and wood screws, yarn, tyres and tubes.

Unit of declaration: See each entry — the Fourth Schedule governs

☐	Sch. IV items 5 and 6	Electric cable and electric wire: length or weight .
☐	Sch. IV item 7	Fencing wire: number or weight .
☐	Sch. IV item 18	Nails and wood screws: number or weight .
☐	Sch. IV item 25	Yarn: weight or length of yarn .
☐	Sch. IV item 24	Tyres and tubes: number .
☐	Sch. I para 2	Where quantity is declared by length, the maximum permissible error is 2 per cent up to 10 metre and 1 per cent thereafter; by number, 2 per cent.
☐	13(2)(b) / 13(3)(b)	Below one metre declare in centimetres; at or above one metre in metres with decimal sub-multiples.
☐	6(1)(f)	Declare dimensions where size is relevant — gauge, diameter and rim size are typically relevant for these goods.

4.3.6. Cement and fertiliser in bags

Applies to: Cement and fertiliser sold in bags up to 50 kg.

Unit of declaration: Weight

☐	3(a)	The only commodities that remain within Chapter II above 25 kg , and only up to 50 kg. A 50 kg cement bag carries the full retail declaration set including MRP.
☐	5 / Sch. II item 17	Cement in bags: 1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 25, 40 kg (40 kg is for white cement only) and 50 kg.
☐	12(2)(a)	Declared by weight.
☐	11(3)	Cement gains and loses moisture; the declaration must still be met without a 'when packed' qualifier, which is unavailable for cement.
☐	18(7)	Retailers under VAT or TOT selling by weight must keep a class III electronic weighing machine on the premises — see Section 6.4.

4.4 Special pack forms and channel-defined categories

4.4.1. Bidi and incense sticks

Applies to: Bidis and incense sticks (agarbatti).

☐	6 proviso A(i)	No month and year of manufacture or pre-packing is required on either bidis or incense sticks.
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☐	6 proviso C(i)	No retail sale price is required on a package containing bidi. Note that this MRP exemption covers bidi only — incense sticks must still carry MRP.
☐	18(4)	The tax-revision price machinery in Rule 18(3) does not apply, since month and year are not required.
☐	6(1)(a),(b),(c)	Manufacturer identity, generic name and net quantity remain mandatory for both.

The asymmetry matters: bidi is exempt from both date and MRP; incense sticks from date only.

4.4.2. Seeds certified under the Seeds Act, 1966

Applies to: Seeds labelled and certified under the Seeds Act, 1966 and the rules made under it.

Unit of declaration: Weight or number

☐	6(1)(d) proviso 2	No month and year declaration is required under these Rules; the Seeds Act labelling regime applies instead.
☐	6(1)(a),(b),(c),(e)	Manufacturer or packer identity, generic name, net quantity and MRP remain governed by these Rules.
☐	26(d)	Seed in packs above 50 kg may fall within the agricultural farm produce exemption — check the pack size before applying the checklist.

4.4.3. Multi-component and combination packs

Applies to: A commodity consisting of several components packed in two or more units and sold as a single commodity.

☐	6(5)	Option A: put the Rule 6(1) declarations on the main pack, and have the main pack also carry information about the other accompanying packs.
☐	6(5)	Option B: give the declarations on the individual packs, and give intimation to that effect on the main pack. One or the other — not neither.
☐	6(5)	If the components are sold as spare parts, every single pack carries the full declaration set. A component that is both bundled and sold loose needs artwork that satisfies the stricter case.
☐	6(1)(b)	For a pack with more than one product, declare the name and number or quantity of each product .
☐	9(3)	An outer shrink-wrap or carton repeats all declarations unless transparent and the inner declarations read clearly through it.

4.4.4. Very small packages

Applies to: Packages of five cubic centimetres or less; and net content of 10 g or 10 ml or less.

☐	26(a)	10 g or 10 ml or less: the Rules do not apply at all. The source text's proviso requiring MRP and net quantity on 10–20 g and 10–20 ml packs is marked as withdrawn w.e.f. 01.07.2012.
☐	7(1)	5 cc or less: the principal display panel may be a card or tape firmly affixed to the pack.
☐	10(1) proviso	5 cc or less: a mark or inscription that lets the consumer identify the manufacturer, packer or importer is sufficient — the full address is not required.
☐	12(7)	5 cc or less: quantity may be declared on a tag, card, tape or similar device affixed so that it cannot be removed without opening the container, and bearing an identifying mark.
☐	7(2)	Numerals height still follows Table I or II — the relaxation is about where the panel sits, not how small the type may be.

Run the size test on the container, not the outer carton. A 3 ml vial inside a 40 cc carton gets the Rule 7(1) relaxation for the vial only.

4.4.5. Imported packages

Applies to: Any package imported for retail sale in India, and foreign-made goods packed in India.

☐	2(k)	An imported package is expressly a retail package — the full Chapter II declaration set applies.
☐	6(1)(a)	The name and address of the importer must be declared, in addition to manufacturer and packer details.
☐	6(1)(d)	Declare the month and year of import where manufacture or pre-packing dates are not used.

☐	10(1) proviso 2	Where a commodity manufactured outside India is packed in India, the principal display panel must also carry the name and complete address of the Indian packer or importer.
☐	27(1)	Importers must register with the Director or Controller with a fee of Rs 500, within ninety days of commencing import.
☐	18(1)	An importer may not sell, distribute, deliver, display or store for sale any package that does not comply in all respects.
☐	6(3)	Stickering the mandatory declarations onto an imported pack is not permitted , except a reduced-MRP sticker. Plan for over-labelling that carries the full declaration set as a securely affixed label under Rule 4, or for repacking.

The practical failure point for imports is Rule 6(3). An import sticker that creates the MRP, importer name or net quantity declaration is vulnerable; a securely affixed label bearing all declarations under Rule 4 is the compliant route.

4.4.6. Export packages sold in India

Applies to: Packages originally made up for export but diverted to the Indian market.

☐	25	An export package may not be sold in India unless the manufacturer or packer has re-packed or re-labelled the commodity in accordance with Chapter II.
☐	25	An export package sold in India without re-packing or re-labelling is liable to be seized under the Act.
☐	25	Note who must do it: the manufacturer or packer . A distributor re-labelling export stock does not satisfy Rule 25.
☐	6(3)	The re-labelling must not take the form of stickers making the mandatory declarations.

Treat export-surplus diversion as a repacking project, not a labelling patch.

5 Reference tables

5.1 First Schedule, Table I — maximum permissible error, weight or volume

Error in excess or in deficiency on the declared net quantity. Rounded to the nearest one-tenth of a gram or millilitre for declared quantities up to 1000 g or ml, and to the next whole gram or millilitre above 1000.

SL.	DECLARED QUANTITY (g or ml)	MPE AS PERCENTAGE OF DECLARED QUANTITY	MPE AS g or ml
(i)	Up to 50	9%	—
(ii)	50 to 100	—	4.5
(iii)	100 to 200	4.5%	—
(iv)	200 to 300	—	9
(v)	300 to 500	3%	—
(vi)	500 to 1000	—	15
(vii)	1000 to 10000	1.5%	—
(viii)	10000 to 15000	—	150
(ix)	More than 15000	1.0%	—

5.2 First Schedule, Table II — maximum permissible error, length, area or number

SL.	QUANTITY DECLARED	MAXIMUM PERMISSIBLE ERROR IN EXCESS OR IN DEFICIENCY
(i)	In units of length	2% of declared quantity up to 10 metre, and 1% thereafter
(ii)	In units of area	4% of declared quantity up to 10 sq. metre, and 1% thereafter
(iii)	By number	2% of declared quantity

5.3 Third Schedule — commodities that may be qualified 'when packed'

SL.	COMMODITY	PRACTICAL EFFECT
1	All kinds of soaps	Rule 21(3) proviso — no punitive action against a retail or wholesale dealer where the officer is satisfied the shortfall is due to environmental conditions
2	Lotions	Same protection; the legend must be used deliberately, not by default
3	Cream other than cream of milk	Cream of milk is expressly outside — a dairy cream pack may not use the legend

5.4 Fourth Schedule — prescribed unit of declaration by commodity

These commodities are the exceptions to Rule 12(2). Where a commodity appears here, the unit in column 3 governs regardless of its physical form.

SL.	COMMODITY	DECLARATION EXPRESSED IN TERMS OF
1	Aerosol products	Weight
2	Acids in liquid form	Weight or volume
3	Compressed or liquefied gas (but not liquefied petroleum gas)	Weight and equivalent volume at stated temperature and pressure
4	Curd	Weight
5	Electric cables	Length or weight
6	Electric wire	Length or weight
7	Fencing wire	Number or weight
8	Fruits, all kinds	Number or weight
9	Furnace oil	Weight or volume
10	Non-edible vegetable oil	Weight or volume
11	Edible oil, vanaspati, ghee and butter oil	Weight or volume
12	Heavy residual fuel oil	Weight
13	Industrial diesel fuel	Volume
14	Honey, malt extract, golden syrup, treacle	Weight
15	Ice cream and other similar frozen products	Volume — replaced by weight w.e.f. 01.07.2012 (G.S.R. 748(E))
16	Liquid chemicals	Weight or volume
17	Liquefied petroleum gas	Weight
18	Nails, wood screws	Number or weight
19	Paints other than paste or solid paint, varnish, varnish stains, enamels	Volume
20	Paste paint, solid paint	Weight
21	Rasgulla, gulabjamun and other sweet preparations	Weight
22	Ready-made garments	Number
23	Sauces, all kinds	Weight
24	Tyres and tubes	Number
25	Yarn	Weight or length of yarn
26	Cosmetics including creams, shampoo, lotions and perfumes	Weight or measure

5.5 Rule 7 — minimum height of numerals on the principal display panel

Table I — where net quantity is declared by weight or volume

SL.	NET QUANTITY IN WEIGHT / VOLUME	MINIMUM HEIGHT, NORMAL CASE (mm)	MINIMUM HEIGHT WHEN BLOWN, FORMED, MOULDED, EMBOSSSED OR PERFORATED (mm)
1	Up to 200 g / ml	1	2
2	Above 200 g / ml and up to 500 g / ml	2	4
3	Above 500 g / ml	4	6

Table II — where net quantity is declared by length, area or number, against the area of the principal display panel

SL.	AREA OF PRINCIPAL DISPLAY PANEL	MINIMUM HEIGHT, NORMAL CASE (mm)	MINIMUM HEIGHT WHEN BLOWN, FORMED, MOULDED, EMBOSSSED OR PERFORATED (mm)
1	Up to 100 cm ²	1	2
2	Above 100 cm ² and up to 500 cm ²	2	4

SL.	AREA OF PRINCIPAL DISPLAY PANEL	MINIMUM HEIGHT, NORMAL CASE (mm)	MINIMUM HEIGHT WHEN BLOWN, FORMED, MOULDED, EMBOSSED OR PERFORATED (mm)
3	Above 500 cm ² and up to 2500 cm ²	4	6
4	Above 2500 cm ²	6	6

Three numbers that are checked together

Numeral height from the table above; letter height of at least 1 mm, or 2 mm when blown, formed, moulded, embossed or perforated (Rule 7(3)); and width of at least one-third of the height, except numeral '1' and letters i, l and I. Add the Rule 8(1) clear space around the quantity declaration — one numeral height above and below, two numeral heights left and right — and the quantity block's footprint is fully determined. Lay this out before the rest of the panel, not after.

6 Wholesale, import, export and the trade channel

6.1 Wholesale packages (Chapter III)

A wholesale package is one containing a number of retail packs intended for an intermediary and not for direct sale to a single consumer; or a commodity sold to an intermediary in bulk for onward sale in smaller quantities; or a pack containing ten or more retail packs, provided those retail packs are themselves labelled as required (Rule 2(r)).

☐	24(a)	Name and address of the manufacturer or importer; or, where the manufacturer or importer is not the packer, of the packer.
☐	24(b)	Identity of the commodity contained in the package.
☐	24(c)	Either the total number of retail packages contained in the wholesale package, or the net quantity in terms of standard units of weight, measure or number.
☐	24	The declaration must be legible, definite, plain and conspicuous .
☐	24 proviso	Rule 24 does not apply where a similar declaration is already required on that wholesale package by or under any other law in force.
☐	24	Note what is absent: a wholesale package does not require MRP, month and year of packing, or the consumer-complaint contact. Adding them is not prohibited, but they are not the Chapter III requirement.
☐	2(r)(iii)	If the outer contains ten or more retail packs, confirm the inner retail packs are fully labelled — otherwise the outer is not a wholesale package and the full Chapter II set applies to it.

6.2 Import (Chapter II read with Rule 27)

☐	6(1)(a)	Importer's name and address declared on every imported retail package.
☐	10(1) proviso 2	For goods manufactured abroad and packed in India, the Indian packer or importer's name and complete address appears on the principal display panel.
☐	27(1)	Importer registered with the Director or Controller, fee Rs 500, within ninety days of commencing import.
☐	18(1)	No import stock is sold, distributed, delivered, displayed or stored for sale unless it complies in all respects.

6.3 Export (Chapter IV)

☐	25	Export packages are not sold in India unless re-packed or re-labelled by the manufacturer or packer in accordance with Chapter II.
☐	25	Non-compliant export packs sold in India are liable to seizure under the Act.

6.4 Wholesale and retail dealer obligations (Rule 18)

☐	18(1)	No wholesale dealer, retail dealer or importer sells, distributes, delivers, displays or stores for sale any packaged commodity unless the package complies in all respects with the Act and these Rules. Storing for sale is enough to attract the rule.
☐	18(2)	No sale above MRP by any retail dealer or other person, including the manufacturer, packer, importer and wholesale dealer.
☐	18(3)	Where tax is revised after pre-packing: the revised price must be communicated by the manufacturer or packer, who must publish it in not less than two advertisements in one or more newspapers and circulate notices to dealers, to the Director in the Central Government and to the Controllers of Legal Metrology in the States and Union Territories.
☐	18(3)	The difference may not exceed the extent of the tax increase or the fresh tax imposed. Newspaper publication is not required where the revision is due to a State tax increase or imposition.
☐	18(3) proviso 2	Revised higher prices may be charged only on packs marked as pre-packed in the month the tax changed or the immediately following month.
☐	18(3) proviso 3	Where the revised price is lower , no price above the revised price may be charged, irrespective of the month of packing . The downward adjustment is immediate and universal.

☐	18(4)	Rule 18(3) does not apply to packs not required to bear month and year — bidi, incense sticks and qualifying PSU LPG cylinders.
☐	18(5)	No dealer may obliterate, smudge or alter the MRP declared by the manufacturer, packer or importer.
☐	18(6)	The manufacturer, packer or importer may not alter the price on a wrapper once printed and used for packing.
☐	18(7)	Retailers covered by VAT or TOT dealing in packaged commodities declared by weight or volume must maintain, at a prominent place in the retail premises and free of cost to consumers, an electronic weighing machine of at least accuracy class III with a smallest division of at least 1 g , able to issue a printed receipt showing gross quantity, price and the like.

7 Registration, inspection readiness and penalty

7.1 Registration of manufacturers, packers and importers (Rules 27–30)

☐	27(1)	Every individual, firm, Hindu undivided family, society, company or corporation that pre-packs or imports any commodity for sale, distribution or delivery has applied to the Director or Controller with a fee of Rs 500 , within ninety days of commencing pre-packing or import.
☐	27(2)	The application states the applicant's name, the complete address of each premises where pre-packing or import is done, and the name of every commodity pre-packed or imported. A new commodity or a new site is a change to be notified.
☐	27(3)	Any alteration in the registration certificate carries a fee of Rs 100 .
☐	27(4)	The Registering Authority returns an incomplete application within seven working days; a complete one is registered and a certificate granted.
☐	28	Where a shorter address is used on labels, it has been registered under Rule 28 in addition to the complete address, and the Director or Controller was satisfied it lets a consumer identify the manufacturer or packer.
☐	29(2)	Note that the register of manufacturers and packers is open to public inspection without fee .

7.2 Inspection readiness at the factory or packing premises (Rules 19–20)

☐	19(1) / Sch. V	Sampling: a lot size below 4000 gives a sample of 32 ; above 4000, a sample of 80 . Samples are drawn at random from the top, bottom, centre, right, left, front and rear of the stock.
☐	2(c)	'Lot' means the total number of packages stored, or for packs on or at the end of the packing line, the maximum hourly output . Know the figure your line reports.
☐	19(6)	A lot is approved only if the statistical average is equal to or above the declared quantity , no sample exceeds the maximum permissible error in deficiency , and every pack bears the required declarations.
☐	19(4)	A fresh test may be requested for good and sufficient reason; the fee is Rs 2,500 and no pack from the previously tested lot may be sold or distributed in the meantime unless Rule 19(5) or (6) is satisfied.
☐	19(5)	Where a lot fails, the manufacturer or packer must make a hundred per cent check and pick out conforming packs; non-conforming packs may not be sold until re-packed, re-processed or re-labelled.
☐	19(7)	Mandatory declarations may be ensured either at the factory or at the factory depot — decide and document which, because the inspection will follow it.
☐	19(8)	On non-compliance, five representative samples are seized as evidence and the rest released once compliance is ensured — amended w.e.f. 01.07.2012 to 'only after the compliance is completed'.
☐	20(1)	On a failed report the officer seizes the samples, keeps them in safe custody for production in court, and initiates action under the Act.
☐	Sch. VI para 2	The officer may use your weights and measures only if their maximum permissible error is 20 per cent or less of the MPE allowed for the commodity. Keep verified working standards that meet this.
☐	Sch. VI para 2(2)	Every manufacturer, packer and wholesale dealer has a duty to render assistance to the officer. Brief the site team.
☐	Sch. VII	Results are recorded in Form A (weight checking) or Form B (volume or length checking) and signed by the manufacturer, packer, authorised agent or a competent witness ; a copy of the data sheet is given to you. Every continuation sheet must bear the Part F signatures — collect them.

7.3 Inspection at dealer premises (Rule 21) and deceptive packages (Rule 23)

☐	21(1)	Quantity testing at a retail or wholesale dealer's premises happens only on a consumer complaint, on suspicion of tampering, pilferage or leakage, or where the declarations are missing.
☐	21(3) proviso	The 'when packed' shield: for the three Third Schedule commodities, no punitive action lies against the dealer if the officer is satisfied after testing that the deficiency is due to environmental conditions.
☐	21(4)	Where the quantity conforms, or the deficiency is within the MPE, the retail dealer may sell at the price determined on the basis of the quantity found.

☐	21(5)	The officer may trace the source from which a non-conforming pack reached the dealer — keep inward documentation that identifies the supplier per lot.
☐	23(1)	Deceptive package: one designed to give a deliberately exaggerated or misleading impression of quantity. Bigger dimensions are defensible only where necessary to protect the commodity or to meet the requirements of the filling machine — record that justification at design stage, before an officer asks.
☐	23(1)	Failure to repack or re-label a deceptive package on requirement leads to seizure and punitive action under the Act.

7.4 Penalties, fees and relaxation

PROVISION	CONTRAVENTION OR EVENT	AMOUNT
Rule 32(1)	Contravention of Rules 27 to 31 — registration of manufacturers, packers and importers; shorter address; the register; circulation of lists; and the advertisement requirement	Rs 4,000
Rule 32(2)	Contravention of any other provision of these Rules for which no punishment is provided in the Act or the Rules	Rs 2,000
Rule 19(4)	Fee for a fresh test carried out at the manufacturer's or packer's request	Rs 2,500
Rule 27(1)	Registration application fee	Rs 500
Rule 27(3)	Fee for alteration in the registration certificate	Rs 100

Rule 33 allows the Central Government, after ascertaining the genuineness of a compounding or court decision stated in the application, to permit a manufacturer or packer to pack for sale for a reasonable period by relaxing one or more provisions, subject to specified corrective measures. Rule 34 repeals the Standards of Weights and Measures (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 1977 while saving prior operations, accrued rights and liabilities, pending proceedings, and registrations and approvals already in force.

7.5 Sign-off

SKU / artwork reference		Product category (Section 4 block)	
Scope gate cleared (Section 1)		Core checklist cleared (Section 2)	
Category deltas cleared (Section 4)		Pack size verified against Sch. II	
Unit verified against Sch. IV		Numeral height and clear space measured	
Reviewed by / date		Approved by / date	

Compiled from the notified text of the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 (G.S.R. 202(E), 7 March 2011), 43 pages, including Schedules I to VII. Provisions marked in the source as withdrawn or amended with effect from 1 July 2012 are identified where they appear. Verify against the current consolidated text before relying on any item for regulatory sign-off.